

Renaissance Music

Overview

- Dates: Approx 1400 -> 1600 AD
- Renaissance means “Rebirth”
 - if something is to be “*reborn*”, then it first has to die
- Term is more appropriate for visual arts / literature
 - rediscovery of Ancient Greek and Roman arts (Classical / Antiquity)
 - * problem: we don’t have very much music from Antiquity
 - * nothing to *go back* to
 - first use of term “Renaissance” to describe this era in the 1850s
 - * during birth / explosion of Musicology

Humanism

- emphasis on knowledge (+ learning) for “good moral character”
- definirely relates to Ancient Greece
 - Humanism
- new ideas of a “cultivated aristocrat”
- Humanism is tied to a growth of education
 - still more restricted by class, sex, race, but more than just “in the church”A
 - education involves:
 - * grammar
 - * logic
 - * rhetoric
- focus on music study as a discipline related to Humanism changes music from science -> humanities
 - new idea of *music as an expressive language*
 - * communicating emotions and thoughts: music has *meaning*